

QUIET HOURS · PEDIATRIC SLEEP WITH DR. LENA PARK



The Evening Rhythm Guide

A calm, printable plan for your baby's
evenings and nights. Fewer decisions after
dark.

For first-time parents, from late pregnancy through the early months.

DR. LENA PARK

Let's make tonight smaller.

Hi, I'm Lena.

When my first baby was born, I had a PhD in developmental psychology and a dissertation on infant routines. And at 3 a.m., I still had no idea what I was doing.

What finally helped was not more research. It was an index card on the fridge with our evening written on it, in order, and a note about who covered which part of the night.

This guide is that index card, done properly.

It won't give you a schedule. Newborns don't read clocks. It gives you a rhythm: the order things happen in. You can always do the order, even on a terrible day.

Use what helps. Skip what doesn't. And on the hard nights, remember: good enough is the goal at 3 a.m.

Let's make tonight smaller.

Lena

Your Evening Rhythm

Same steps. Same order. Every evening. About 20 to 40 minutes.

The steps matter less than the order. Each step has a “good enough” version for the nights when the full version isn't happening. Those nights count too.

- 1

Bath or wash
 It marks the line between day and evening.
GOOD ENOUGH A warm washcloth over hands and face. Fresh pajamas.
- 2

Feed
 A calm, unhurried feed is a natural anchor for the evening.
GOOD ENOUGH Feed however works tonight, wherever you are. The order is what counts. (Feeding questions go to your pediatrician or lactation consultant.)
- 3

Dim the lights
 Lower light signals the busy part of the day is over, for both of you.
GOOD ENOUGH Switch off the big overhead light. One lamp is plenty.
- 4

One book
 A short, quiet moment that sounds the same every night.
GOOD ENOUGH Say the same few sentences as yesterday. “The day is done. The lights are low. Time to rest.”
- 5

One song
 Your voice, repeated, becomes part of the rhythm.
GOOD ENOUGH Hum the same tune. No words needed, and you don't need to sing well.
- 6

Down
 The rhythm ends in the same place every night.
GOOD ENOUGH Down, on their back, in a safe sleep space set up the way current AAP guidance describes (see Page 2).

OUR EVENING, IN ORDER	AFTER MIDNIGHT, WHO DOES WHAT
1 _____	First stretch _____
2 _____	Second stretch _____
3 _____	
4 _____	
5 _____	
6 _____	

The Room Checklist

Get the room ready in daylight, before you're exhausted.

This checklist follows safe sleep basics as published by the American Academy of Pediatrics (AAP). Safe sleep guidance is updated over time, so always follow current AAP guidance and ask your pediatrician about anything specific to your baby.

SLEEP SURFACE (FROM AAP SAFE SLEEP GUIDANCE)

- ☐ Baby placed on their back for every sleep, as recommended by the AAP.
- ☐ A firm, flat sleep surface with nothing else in it, as recommended by the AAP.
- ☐ I've checked current AAP safe sleep guidance and asked my pediatrician any questions about our setup.

TEMPERATURE

- ☐ I've asked my pediatrician how to dress my baby for sleep, and I follow current AAP guidance on avoiding overheating.
- ☐ The room feels comfortable to me, not too warm and not too cold.

SOUND

- ☐ The evening is a little quieter than the day: TV down, voices low.
- ☐ If we use a sound machine, I've read the manufacturer's instructions and keep the volume low.

LIGHT

- ☐ Evening lights can be dimmed, or one lamp is enough.
- ☐ A small, low light for night feeds and changes, so the big light stays off.
- ☐ Brighter by day, dim by night.

READY BEFORE DARK

- ☐ Diapers and wipes within reach.
- ☐ Burp cloths and a spare change of clothes nearby.
- ☐ Water and a snack for me.
- ☐ Phone charger by my chair.
- ☐ This guide on the fridge, where everyone can see it.

For anything about your baby's health, feeding, breathing, or safe sleep, talk to your pediatrician.

When the night goes sideways

The Pause and Read: three steps for night wakings.

When your baby wakes, it's easy to respond to the panic instead of to your baby. This is not "let them cry." It's "look before you leap."

STEP 1

Pause

Take one slow breath before you move. Just one. It gives your own body a second to settle.

STEP 2

Read

Look at what you're actually seeing.

- Could this be hunger?
- Could this be discomfort? (A wet diaper, too warm, a burp.)
- Could my baby be moving between sleep cycles, stirring and settling?

STEP 3

Respond

Respond to what you read, not to the worry. Feed if it's hunger. Help with the discomfort. If it looks like a transition, give it a moment and stay close.

IMPORTANT

If you are ever worried about your baby's breathing, color, or health, trust that worry. Contact your pediatrician or emergency services right away. The Pause and Read is for ordinary night wakings, never for a concern about your baby's health.

Make tonight smaller.

You don't need to fix the whole month. Just tonight. One step from Page 1, in the same order as yesterday. If the night goes sideways anyway, that's not failure. That's a baby. Good enough is the goal at 3 a.m.

You are not doing it wrong.

Lena

Want the full plan? First 90 Nights opens November 4. Waitlist members get the founding price. [DOMAIN]

Quiet Hours and First 90 Nights are educational and do not replace medical advice. Dr. Lena Park holds a PhD in developmental psychology and is a certified pediatric sleep consultant; she is not a medical doctor. For questions about your baby's health, feeding, breathing, or safe sleep, talk to your pediatrician and follow current AAP guidance. © 2026 Quiet Hours · @quiethours.sleep